

THE MOVE

Formula: notice shared context -> name it simply -> add an easy entry point -> pause -> follow the thread they choose. -> **Social:** "Looks like we both ended up in the quieter corner. I am Sam." -> **Meeting:** "The shared question today is whether ?

START HERE

Name the shared context in one ordinary line, then give the other person an easy way to enter: "Looks like we are both waiting for the same session. I am Sam."

SAY THIS

Shared setting / imm...	"Looks like we both picked the busy time."
Waiting / event / soci...	"Have you been to one of these before, or is this your first time too?"
Task / meeting opener	"Before we get into the detail, the main thing today is to align on the next step."
Professional / client / ...	"Before we start, I know there can be a lot of admin around this. I will keep the opening brief."
Group opener	"Before we go around the room, I want to name what we are here to decide."
Time / transition ope...	"Coming back after a break can be a bit clunky. Where did we leave it?"

AVOID

- The context is not actually shared.
- The situation calls for direct action rather than social entry.
- The person is clearly unavailable, distressed, time-pressured or needing privacy.

REMEMBER

The safest opener is often a boringly accurate one.